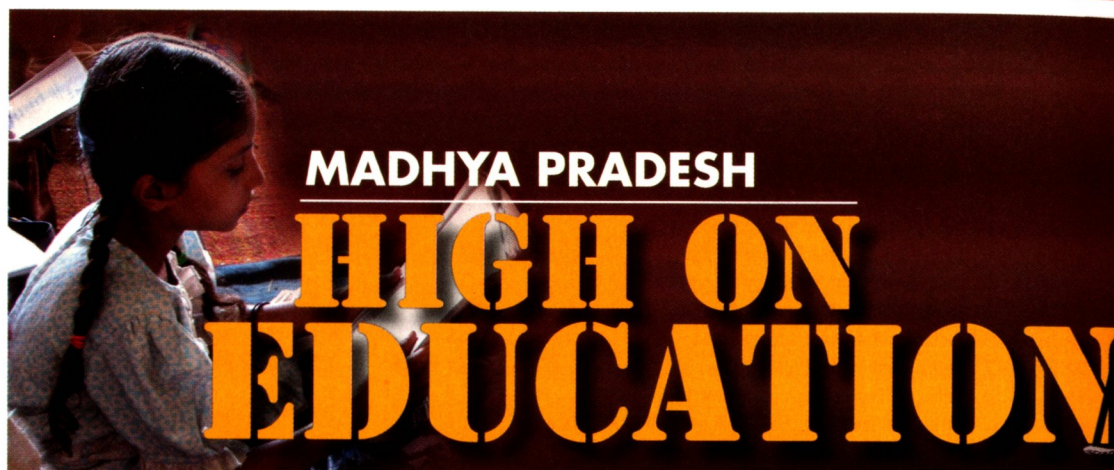




MADHYA PRADESH HIGH ON EDUCATION

In last four years, the present Madhya Pradesh government led by Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan has lived up to the expectation of ensuring quality education and better educational facilities to the youth. Having been dubbed as an educationally backward state for a long time, Madhya Pradesh is now emerging as an education hub due to the changes coming thick and fast in education scenario. A report:

■ Prospering Government Schools

Government School Results Vs Private School Results:

Year	Private High School Results (%)	Govt. High School Results (%)	Difference (%)
2002-03	32.47	19.21	13.26
2003-04	36.04	22.44	13.60
2004-05	39.16	27.84	11.32
2005-06	45.24	38.40	6.84
2006-07	46.55	49.36	-2.81

The high school results of government schools have improved considerably over the years. In year 2003-04 the result was 22.44 percent, which increased to 49.36 percent in 2006-07. A very notable thing is that out of total 36 students who figured on the merit list of 2007 high school examinations, 11 were from government schools. Another important thing is that in 2006-07 examination the high school results of government schools were better at 49.36 percent than the private schools which reported only 46.55 pass percentage.

In year 2003 a total of 7 lakh 74 thousand children of school going age were out of school. Now only 65 thousand children are out of school. Efforts are continuing to enroll them in schools next year.

At present, there are 95 thousand 517 primary schools of which 81 thousand 335 are government and remaining are private ones in which 1 crore 12 lakh 74 thousand children are enrolled. Similarly, the state has 35 thousand 899 middle schools of which 24 thousand are 293 government and remaining are private. A total of 42 lakh 53 students are enrolled in them.

■ Furthermore

- The Gross Enrollment Rate (GER) at primary level was 101.7 percent in year 2003, which has increased to 104.6 percent this year. At middle level, the rate was 74 percent, which has gone up to 95.3 per cent this year. Similarly, the Net Enrollment Rate (NER) at primary level was 82 percent in year 2003, which has increased to 95.9 percent while at middle level, it has increased from 66 percent in 2003 to 88.2 percent this year.
- The dropout rate at primary level was 25.6 percent in 2003, which has

gone down to 17.6 percent while at middle level it has decreased from 26.6 percent to 16.3 percent.

- In year 2003, there were 26 thousand 411 primary schools without building. So far, construction of buildings for 22 thousand 272 of these schools has already been completed and work on remaining 4 thousand 139 ones is in progress. Similarly, there were 2 thousand 166 middle schools without building. With the addition of 13 thousand 536 new schools from year 2003 to 2007, the number of such schools rose to 15 thousand 522.

■ Strengthening Colleges

Over the last four years, the Shivraj Singh Chouhan government has followed the policy of not opening new colleges and to strengthen the existing 302 ones instead which has witnessed praiseworthy results.

Computer education has been introduced at graduate level to improve their competitiveness in this age of computer and IT. Besides, automation of libraries of 88 colleges is in progress. A scheme is ready to take up another 80 colleges for library automation by end of the current financial year.

The amount of scholarship provided to scheduled caste and scheduled tribe students for research work has been increased from Rs. 5000 to Rs. 8000. The books and stationery allowance for these students has also been increased.

Entrepreneurship development, computer education and environment education have been introduced in the foundation course of the first year of graduation for expansion of IT education and implementation of the Industrial Promotion Policy of the state government. Career guidance cells and placement cells have been set up in all the colleges.

Also, sanctions have been released for construction of 52 college buildings in last four years. There is a target to construct buildings of all the colleges. At present, 84 colleges do not have their own buildings. Construction of buildings for 54 of these colleges is in progress. Additional funds have been released for construction work.

In order to complete teaching work Assistant Professors have been appointed on 871 vacant backlog posts. As many as 39 principals of postgraduate colleges have been promoted and principals have been appointed in 164 postgraduate colleges. Besides, 87 casual Assistant Professors have been regularized. In all, teachers have been placed in selection and senior pay scale in 2468 pending cases.